Academic Research Paper

CSN Sociology — Social Media's Impact on Las Vegas Tourism

100 pts / 100 points

Unit 2 — Word Processing · Variation 1

How to use this instruction sheet: Download the starter file from the Project Grader, open it in Microsoft Word 365, and keep this sheet open beside it. Work through each task in order. Each task tells you what to do, why it matters, and where to find the tool — but you must figure out the exact steps yourself. That's the learning.

Screen Recording Requirement

To verify your own work, record yourself completing 3 tasks while working on this project.

- Use Xbox Game Bar (press Win+G) or Loom (loom.com — free account) to record your screen
- Show yourself completing any 3 tasks from the list below
- Submit the recording to Canvas along with your completed file

D1 — Manage Documents

16 points (6 tasks)

3 Task 1 — Set 1-inch margins on all sides (APA standard)

WHY THIS MATTERS

APA style requires consistent 1-inch margins on every side so the page layout matches academic publishing conventions.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Layout tab → Page Setup group → Margins → Custom Margins → set Top, Bottom, Left, and Right to 1" → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The ruler shows the 1-inch margin boundary on all four sides of the page.

2 Task 2 — Set orientation to Portrait

WHY THIS MATTERS

Academic papers are always read in Portrait orientation — taller than wide — matching standard printing and binding conventions.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Layout tab → Page Setup group → Orientation → Portrait.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The page is taller than it is wide (standard 8.5" × 11").

2 Task 3 — Apply the "Basic (Simple)" style set

WHY THIS MATTERS

A style set changes the fonts and colors of all built-in styles at once, giving the paper a clean, academic look with one click.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Design tab → Document Formatting group → the Style Sets gallery → hover to preview → select "Basic (Simple)."

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The document's heading fonts and colors change to match the Basic (Simple) theme.

4 Task 4 — Insert running head: left-aligned title, right-aligned page number

WHY THIS MATTERS

APA papers use a running head — a shortened title in the header — so readers can identify the paper on every page, even if pages are separated.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Header & Footer group → Header → Edit Header. Type the short title, press Tab twice to jump right, then Insert → Page Number → Current Position.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Every page shows the short title on the left side of the header and a page number on the right.

2 Task 5 — Insert page numbers top-right in header

WHY THIS MATTERS

Page numbers in APA format always appear in the top-right corner, distinct from the body text, so pages can be tracked when printed.

WHERE TO FIND IT

While in the header, place your cursor after the title → Header & Footer tab → Page Number → Current Position → Plain Number.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Each page shows its correct page number in the top-right corner.

3 Task 6 — Set document properties: Title, Author (your name), Subject

WHY THIS MATTERS

Document properties store metadata about the paper — useful for identifying the file and required for many academic submission systems.

WHERE TO FIND IT

File → Info → Properties panel on the right → fill in Title, fill in Author with your name, fill in Subject.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The Properties panel shows your typed Title, Author, and Subject values.

D2 — Format Text & Paragraphs 25 points (8 tasks)

3 Task 7 — Find & Replace: "SM" → "social media"

WHY THIS MATTERS

Using a shorthand abbreviation while drafting and then expanding it everywhere ensures consistent, formal terminology throughout the final paper.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Home tab → Editing group → Replace → type "SM" in Find, type "social media" in Replace → Replace All.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Every instance of "SM" in the paper now reads "social media."

2 Task 8 — Apply Title style to the paper title

WHY THIS MATTERS

The built-in Title style formats the paper's main title distinctly from body text and headings, matching academic formatting standards.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click into the title text → Home tab → Styles gallery → Title.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The title's font and size visibly change to match the Title style preview in the gallery.

4 Task 9 — Apply Heading 1 to Introduction, Lit Review, Methodology, Results, Conclusion, References

WHY THIS MATTERS

Heading 1 marks each major chapter of the paper, which is required for the Table of Contents to find and list them correctly.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click into each chapter title → Home tab → Styles gallery → Heading 1. Repeat for all six chapter titles.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

All six chapter titles share the same Heading 1 font, size, and color.

4 Task 10 — Apply Heading 2 to all subsections within each chapter

WHY THIS MATTERS

Heading 2 marks subsections within a chapter, creating a clear visual hierarchy beneath each Heading 1.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click into each subsection title → Home tab → Styles gallery → Heading 2.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Subsection titles appear smaller than chapter titles but still visually distinct from body text.

3 Task 11 — Set line spacing to double (2.0) for entire document

WHY THIS MATTERS

APA format requires double-spacing throughout the paper so instructors and reviewers have room to write comments between lines.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select all text (Ctrl+A) → Home tab → Paragraph group → Line and Paragraph Spacing → 2.0.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

There is visibly twice the vertical space between each line of text compared to single spacing.

3 Task 12 — Set first-line indent of 0.5 inches on all body paragraphs

WHY THIS MATTERS

APA format requires the first line of every body paragraph to be indented 0.5 inches, distinguishing new paragraphs without extra blank lines.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the body paragraphs → Layout tab → Paragraph group → Indent dialog launcher → Special → First Line → 0.5".

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The first line of each body paragraph starts 0.5 inches further right than the rest of the paragraph.

4 Task 13 — Apply Intense Quote character style to a direct quotation

WHY THIS MATTERS

A character style visually sets a direct quotation apart from the surrounding text, signaling to the reader that the words are taken verbatim from a source.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the quotation text → Home tab → Styles gallery → Intense Quote.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The quotation's font color and weight change to match the Intense Quote preview, distinct from regular body text.

2 Task 14 — Insert page break before the References section

WHY THIS MATTERS

Starting References on a fresh page keeps the citation list visually separate from the paper's body content.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click right before the References heading → Insert tab → Pages group → Page Break.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The References heading starts at the top of a new page, with nothing else on that page above it.

D3 — Tables & Lists

16 points (6 tasks)

4 Task 15 — Create 4-column survey results data table

WHY THIS MATTERS

A table presents the survey's numeric results far more clearly than describing them in paragraph form, letting readers compare values at a glance.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Tables group → Table → drag to select 4 columns and the number of rows needed → click to insert.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A table with 4 distinct columns and visible borders appears in the document.

3 Task 16 — Merge header row cells for spanning title

WHY THIS MATTERS

Merging the header row into one wide cell lets a single title span the full width of the table, clearly labeling what the data below represents.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select all cells in the top row → Table Layout tab → Merge group → Merge Cells.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The top row appears as one single wide cell instead of four separate cells.

3 Task 17 — Sort data table by response percentage (descending)

WHY THIS MATTERS

Sorting from highest to lowest percentage immediately highlights the most significant survey findings at the top of the table.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click inside the table → Table Layout tab → Data group → Sort → choose the percentage column → Descending → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Rows are now ordered from the highest percentage value at the top to the lowest at the bottom.

2 Task 18 — Create numbered list of research questions

WHY THIS MATTERS

A numbered list lets the paper reference research questions by number later (e.g., "as shown in Question 2"), which a paragraph or bullets cannot do as clearly.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Type each research question on its own line → select all the lines → Home tab → Numbering button.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Each research question is preceded by a sequential number (1, 2, 3...).

2

Task 19 — Create bulleted list of key findings

WHY THIS MATTERS

A bulleted list presents key findings as distinct, scannable points rather than a dense paragraph, which is easier for a reader to skim.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Type each finding on its own line → select all the lines → Home tab → Bullets button.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Each finding is preceded by a bullet point (•) instead of a number.

2

Task 20 — Restart list numbering for a second set of research questions

WHY THIS MATTERS

When two separate numbered lists appear in the same document, restarting the second list at 1 keeps each set logically self-contained instead of continuing the count from the first list.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Right-click the first item of the second list → Restart at 1.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The second list of research questions begins again at "1," not continuing from where the first list left off.

D4 — References

12 points (3 tasks)

4

Task 21 — Insert Table of Contents after title page

WHY THIS MATTERS

A Table of Contents lets readers jump directly to any chapter without scrolling through the entire paper, and is expected in formal academic submissions.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click on a blank page after the title page → References tab → Table of Contents group → Table of Contents → Automatic Table 1.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A list of chapter titles with page numbers appears, generated automatically from your Heading styles.

4

Task 22 — Customize TOC: Heading 1 and Heading 2 only

WHY THIS MATTERS

Limiting the Table of Contents to two heading levels keeps it concise, showing chapters and subsections without listing every minor heading.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click inside the existing TOC → References tab → Table of Contents → Custom Table of Contents → set "Show levels" to 2 → OK → Yes to replace.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The TOC now lists only chapter titles and their subsections, not any deeper heading levels.

4 Task 23 — Insert 5 footnotes citing sources throughout the paper

WHY THIS MATTERS

Footnotes let the paper cite a source at the exact point a claim is made, without interrupting the sentence with an in-text citation.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click right after the text needing a citation → References tab → Footnotes group → Insert Footnote → type the citation. Repeat for all 5 citations.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Each citation shows a small superscript number in the body text, with matching numbered notes at the bottom of the page.

D5 — Graphic Elements

21 points (5 tasks)

4 Task 24 — Insert bar chart screenshot showing survey data

WHY THIS MATTERS

A visual chart communicates the shape of the survey data — which platforms influence decisions most — far faster than a table of numbers alone.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Illustrations group → Pictures → This Device → select the chart image file → Insert.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The chart image appears in the document at the location of your cursor.

2 Task 25 — Set text wrapping to Top and Bottom for the figure

WHY THIS MATTERS

Top and Bottom wrapping keeps the chart on its own horizontal band, with text only above and below it, never beside it — common for figures in academic papers.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click the chart to select it → Picture Format tab → Arrange group → Wrap Text → Top and Bottom.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Body text appears only above and below the chart, never wrapping along its sides.

4 Task 26 — Add text to a shape to create a callout box for a key statistic

WHY THIS MATTERS

A callout box visually highlights one key statistic so it stands out from the surrounding paragraphs instead of being buried in regular text.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Illustrations group → Shapes → choose a shape (e.g., Rounded Rectangle) → draw it → right-click → Add Text → type the statistic.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A shape containing the key statistic text appears on the page, visually distinct from the body paragraphs.

4 Task 27 — Position the callout shape in the right margin

WHY THIS MATTERS

Positioning the callout in the margin lets it sit alongside the related paragraph without interrupting the flow of the main text.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click the shape → Shape Format tab → Arrange group → Position → More Layout Options → set a fixed position relative to the right margin → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The shape sits in the white space of the right margin, beside the body text rather than inside it.

7 Task 28 — Add descriptive alt text to all figures

WHY THIS MATTERS

Alt text describes an image for screen readers, making the paper accessible to readers with visual impairments and meeting accessibility requirements.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Right-click each image or shape → Edit Alt Text → type a clear description of what the figure shows.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Each figure has a description entered in its Alt Text panel.

D6 — Collaboration

10 points (3 tasks)

2 Task 29 — Add comment asking professor for feedback on thesis statement

WHY THIS MATTERS

A comment lets you flag a specific sentence for feedback without altering the actual text of the paper.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the thesis statement → Review tab → Comments group → New Comment → type your question.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A comment balloon appears attached to the thesis statement with your question visible.

4 Task 30 — Reply to comment from writing partner

WHY THIS MATTERS

Replying within the same comment thread keeps the conversation about that specific feedback organized and easy to follow later.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click on the existing comment from your writing partner → click Reply → type your response.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Your reply appears nested underneath the original comment in the same thread.

4

Task 31 — Turn on Track Changes; revise the methodology section

WHY THIS MATTERS

Track Changes records every edit you make as a visible insertion or deletion, so a reader can see exactly what changed in the methodology section.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Review tab → Tracking group → Track Changes → turn it on → revise the methodology section text.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Your edits appear as colored, underlined insertions and struck-through deletions rather than silently replacing the original text.